

NCSA: supercomputing in Urbana, research traffic to Chicago

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: ZoomInfo, Apollo

~306 NCSA staff	Urbana HQ (1205 W Clark St)	2 UIUC network leaders found	0 touches so far
STAGE Untouched prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW Not in any Lemlist campaign	LAST TOUCH None	NEXT STEP Wed Oct 7: email Mike Smeltzer (Director of Networking, UIUC)

Bottom line

NCSA is the University of Illinois' supercomputing center (about 306 staff). It runs large AI and research systems whose data moves between Urbana and the research exchange points in Chicago. ZoomInfo shows no signals; university buying runs on long cycles. HubSpot has no contacts. Apollo found the campus network leaders: **Mike Smeltzer, Director of Networking (UIUC, ex-McLeodUSA)** and **Brad Mahaffey, Deputy CIO for Enterprise Infrastructure**. The fit is **diverse Chicago-side paths** for research traffic. Open a relationship now for future procurements.

What NCSA is, in one analogy

NCSA is a power plant in Urbana that ships electricity (data) to Chicago. Its transmission lines need a second, separate route into the city.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
No intent or scoops	ZoomInfo	Long-cycle public buyer.
Mike Smeltzer, Director of Networking (UIUC); ex-McLeodUSA	Apollo	Knows carrier fiber.
Brad Mahaffey, Deputy CIO, Enterprise Infrastructure (since Jun 2025)	Apollo	Infrastructure sponsor.

Work already in motion

No activity.

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
-	-	No HubSpot or Lemlist activity	Fresh

Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Mike Smeltzer	Director of Networking (Apollo)	Champaign	Network owner.	Not contacted. smeltzer@illinois.edu (verified)
Brad Mahaffey	Deputy CIO, Enterprise Infrastructure (Apollo)	Champaign	Sponsor.	Not contacted. bmahaffe@illinois.edu (verified)
(to find)	NCSA networking lead	Urbana	NCSA-specific owner.	Ask Smeltzer

Not worth chasing for this goal

Campus facilities and departmental IT.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Mike Smeltzer Director of Networking

Why them: Network owner; ex-carrier.

Channel: Email Wed Oct 7 | Subject: Chicago-side diversity for Illinois research traffic

Mike, from your McLeodUSA days you know Chicago's shared-duct problem. Crosstown owns underground fiber in Chicago, mapped to the conduit, on-net at 350 E Cermak and Elk Grove. If NCSA or campus traffic needs a provably separate Chicago-side path, I'd like to share the map. Who at NCSA should see it?

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Wed Oct 7	Email Mike Smeltzer.	-
Wed Oct 14	Email Brad Mahaffey if silent.	-
Nov	Watch Illinois procurement for network RFPs.	Ongoing.

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 21	Reply or NCSA referral	Logged
Dec 15	Intro meeting	Meeting logged

Guardrails

- Public university: expect formal procurement.
- Credits used: ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company; 2 Apollo person enrichments.

Sources

ZoomInfo firmographics; Apollo people data.